

LIGHTING UNLIMITED × SHOPIFY

A self-serve B2B storefront — without leaving DDI behind

A branded, login-gated ordering portal where your contractors and accounts log in, see their own pricing, and place orders on their own — so counter sales scale without the phone calls and paper tickets.

Shopify Plus · B2B portal · DDI-integrated · 4 Arizona branches

OVERVIEW

Where Shopify fits

Lighting Unlimited is a lighting & electrical distributor serving the greater Phoenix Valley from four branches, with roughly 92% of sales B2B. The opportunity isn't a new sales team — it's giving the customers you already serve a faster way to buy.

The problem today

Nearly every order runs through a person — walk-ins, phone calls, and manually written tickets on a pre-coded pricing matrix. It works, but as the company scales, the overhead to handle all those manual transactions gets heavy. There's no online interface for the customers who just want to log in and re-order at their agreed pricing.

The goal

A branded, gated storefront (e.g. an LU-owned domain "powered by Shopify") where account customers log in to their own tier pricing and self-serve — while **DDI stays your source of truth** and the big, complex spec jobs stay exactly where they are.

Guardrail we'll respect: manufacturers (Acuity, Philips, Lutron, Minka, etc.) restrict public online listing. Everything sits **behind a login on your own branded site** — not on a public marketplace — which keeps you inside your buying-group and channel agreements.

CURRENT STATE

How it works right now

A quick map of today's stack and the three ways customers buy — so we only rebuild what's worth rebuilding.

Systems today

- **ERP:** DDI (distributor ERP) — stays the system of record; you may evaluate NetSuite down the line
- **E-commerce:** none currently (previous site retired); manual listings on Amazon & eBay, low volume
- **Payments:** a separate card processor (buying-group negotiated rates); most sales are on terms / AR
- **Buying group:** Affiliated Distributors — channel & pricing agreements to preserve

Three ways customers buy

- **Counter & pop-up pricing** — walk-in / phone, pre-coded tier pricing. ← **the best fit to move online**
- **Outside sales / spec jobs** — complex quotes, large POs (e.g. \$100k retrofits). Stays in DDI
- **Municipal / contract** — blanket POs & pre-negotiated annual pricing; one city requires an online PO portal

Pricing complexity

Tiers today are bronze / silver / gold, moving toward a cleaner bronze / silver / gold / platinum model — with customer-category modifiers (electrician vs. general contractor vs. property management). Net terms (net 30 / 45 / 60) are common. This tier count is the main thing that decides the plan (below).

USE CASES

What we'd build on Shopify

Straight from our conversation — mapped to Shopify B2B capabilities. Core = we'll validate feasibility in the technical discovery.

Self-serve ordering

CORE

Account customers log in and place their own orders at their agreed pricing — no phone call or counter visit required.

Login-gated catalog

CORE

Products visible only after login on your branded site — protects manufacturer channel rules and buying-group agreements.

Customer-specific pricing & tiers

CORE

Catalogs & price lists per company/tier (bronze→platinum) plus category modifiers, driven by who's logged in.

B2B payment terms

CORE

Net 30 / 45 / 60 and pay-on-account, so online ordering matches how your customers already pay.

Municipal / contract portal

CORE

Upload pre-negotiated blanket pricing — covers the city that requires an online portal to cut POs.

DDI integration

CORE

Orders & fulfillment sync with DDI; outside-sales quotes handled as draft orders; complex jobs stay in DDI.

Payments & Shop Pay

COMPARE

Shopify Payments unlocks Shop Pay; or keep an approved third-party processor (+~0.2% on Plus). We'll compare vs. your buying-group rate.

In-store POS

OPTIONAL

Unify counter sales across the four branches on Shopify POS later — weighed against your current processor's value.

Explicitly out of scope for now: the large, complex spec/quote jobs and \$100k POs — those stay in DDI. Shopify targets the repeatable counter & account ordering that eats the most manual time.

PLANS & PRICING

Shopify Plus

Your model — four pricing tiers with category modifiers, net payment terms, municipal contract pricing and a login-gated catalog — needs the full B2B suite. That points to **one plan: Shopify Plus**. The core plans cap catalogs and price lists and can't handle this pricing structure.

YOUR PLAN

Shopify Plus

\$2,300 /mo base

At ~\$20M B2B revenue you're above the ~\$7.9M threshold, so billing runs on the Variable Platform Fee — **~\$3,000/mo effective** (see below). Full B2B suite, built for your pricing model.

- **Unlimited** companies, customer catalogs & price lists
- **Tiered pricing** — bronze / silver / gold / platinum + category modifiers
- **Net payment terms** (net 30/45/60) & pay-on-account
- Login-gated B2B storefront + wholesale & D2C on one store
- Municipal / contract catalogs with pre-negotiated pricing
- Draft orders, checkout customization, expansion stores

Payments

Shopify Payments — standard cards	2.25% + 30¢
Shopify Payments — Amex	2.95% + 30¢
Approved third-party processor (keep yours)	+ ~0.2% on Plus

Platform cost at your volume

You pay the **higher of** the \$2,300/mo base or the Variable Platform Fee (VPF). At **~\$20M in revenue** you're above the ~\$7.9M threshold, so VPF applies — and it's charged by channel. Because you're **~92% B2B**, the rate that matters is the lowest one:

B2B — your primary channel	0.18%
Retail (POS)	0.25%
D2C (online)	0.35%
Effective platform cost — B2B 0.18% × ~\$20M	≈ \$36,000/yr (~\$3,000/mo)

Effective platform cost based on ~\$20M annual revenue at the B2B VPF rate (0.18%); final figure moves with your actual revenue and channel mix. Card rates are standard published rates, confirmed at underwriting; incentives confirmed on the order form.

NEXT STEPS

Plan forward — launch January 1

Working backward from a January 1 go-live, with the partner engaged now so the DDI integration is scoped and the build starts in early October.

● Sept 15 · booked

Partner intro & scoping with Solo Media Group — the build, DDI integration and data migration, plus a real read on cost and effort.

● Late September

Finalize scope + pricing and sign — this locks the current incentive and protects the runway to Jan 1.

● Early October

Kickoff — build begins.

● October – December

~3-month build: login-gated B2B portal, tiered pricing, net terms, DDI integration, catalog.

● Mid-December

UAT & testing — validate the B2B flows and integration before launch.

● January 1 · go-live

Launch on Shopify Plus.

The one thing that protects Jan 1: signing by end of September. If anything on your side would push that, let's flag it early and adjust. Helpful before Sept 15: your DDI / data details so Solo Media Group can scope fast.

Also good to confirm: final tier structure for the catalogs, the must-have municipal portal, and whether POS across the four branches is in or out for v1.

Prepared by Nicole DeGennaro · Shopify — for Lighting Unlimited. Built from our intro call. B2B feasibility confirmed in technical discovery; pricing & scope finalized with an implementation partner.